

OSSEC works on a server-client model. The OSSEC server must be installed on a Linux/UNIX machine and the client (also called agent) can be installed on any operating system. It could be a cloud-based instance as well.

Multiple installation options are available with OSSEC—it could be installed on a standalone machine or a multihost scenario, where one installation is a server and the other is an agent. The communication between the OSSEC server and agent is always encrypted.

OSSEC works well with cloud instances. We can install OSSEC servers and agents on AWS instances and can monitor file integrity checking, real time file monitoring and log inspections.

Snort

Snort is a fully open source network intrusion prevention system (NIPS) and network intrusion detection system (NIDS). It can perform real time analytics on IP networks.

Snort has three main modes of working—as a sniffer, a packet logger and network intrusion detection. It can be used with AWS and EC2 instances also. Snort host-based IDS supports tracking of running processes, detection of configuration changes, tracking of file access and detection of any abnormal behaviour.

Snort provides in-flight data encryption for cloud instances like in AWS. All incoming traffic passes through the elastic load balancer, which is used as an HTTPS terminator. It works like proxy traffic for back-end IDS instances as HTTP. Snort is used here for packet analysis and to decide whether to reject or accept the packet. After transmission, Snort analyses the outbound packet and logs the results.

CryptSync

The best way to protect files is to encrypt them before moving them to other servers. CryptSync provides an

additional layer of security, which makes it difficult for attackers to view files.

CryptSync uses two folders which work synchronously. One folder contains current working files which are unencrypted and the other folder contains encrypted files.

Crypton

Crypton has been developed by SpiderOak and licensed under the AGPL. Crypton enables applications to encrypt data in the Web browser itself before moving to cloud locations.

Crypton libraries allow developers to write secure cloud applications where all data is encrypted on the client side itself before moving to cloud storage.

Crypton basically supports the JavaScript library for Web applications that offer an object storage API. The data storage backend of Crypton is built with compatibility to PostgreSQL, Redis and Node.js.

TrueCrypt

TrueCrypt is an open source disk encryption application. It provides real time and transparent encryption. It creates a virtual encrypted disk within a file and mounts it as a real disk.

TrueCrypt supports Linux, Mac OS and the Windows platform. AWS Import/Export supporting device encryption uses TrueCrypt for import to Amazon S3 and export from Amazon S3. 

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OSFY Magazine Attractions During 2013-14

MONTH	THEME	FEATURED LIST
March 2013	Virtualisation	Virtualisation Solution Providers
April 2013	Open source Databases	Certification & Training Solution Providers
May 2013	Network Monitoring	Mobile Apps
June 2013	Open Source application development	Cloud
July 2013	Open Source on Windows	Web Hosting Providers
August 2013	Open Source Firewall and Network security	E-mail Service Providers
September 2013	Android Special	Gadgets
October 2013	Kernel Special	IT Consultancy
November 2013	Cloud Special	IT Hardware
December 2013	Linux & Open Source Powered Data Storage	Network Storage
January 2014	Open Source for Web development and deployment	Security
February 2014	Top 10 of Everything on Open Source	IT Infrastructure